

The Other Emirate

Just an hour away from Dubai, Ras Al Khaimah offers a more laid-back alternative to its glamorous neighbour

BY SMITA TRIPATHI



“Where is that?” asked an aunt on the family WhatsApp group. “I thought you were visiting Dubai,” another friend pinged in response to my announcement of my visit to Ras Al Khaimah, a tiny emirate in the UAE, just over an hour’s drive from the heart of Dubai. Well, *they* may not have heard of the northernmost emirate with an uninterrupted history of over 7,000 years, but RAK (as it is commonly abbreviated) has recently become a popular destination for Indian travellers, whose numbers grew 20% last year. In fact, India is the fifth-largest source market of Ras Al Khaimah after Russia, Germany, the UK, and Kazakhstan.

Historically considered a significant trade centre, RAK has in recent years become an attractive escape for those seeking adventure or a laid-back beach holiday.